



Extreme emotions

The limbic system is highly reactive in teenagers, meaning they experience heightened emotional responses, feeling things more deeply.



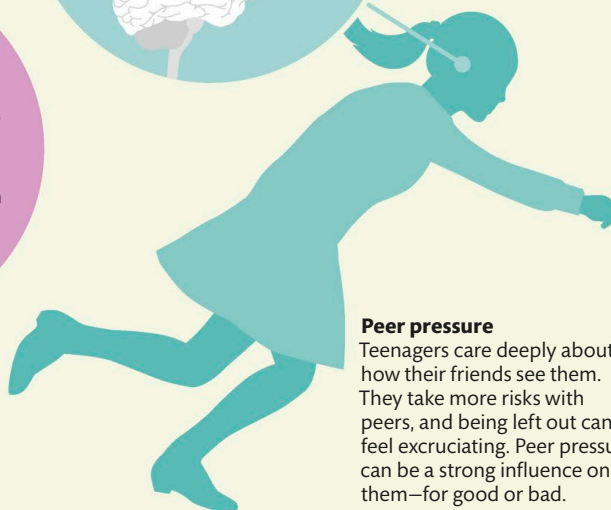
Limbic system

Clumsiness

During rapid growth spurts, the brain's body maps can't keep up. Brain and body get out of sync, causing clumsiness.



Motor cortex

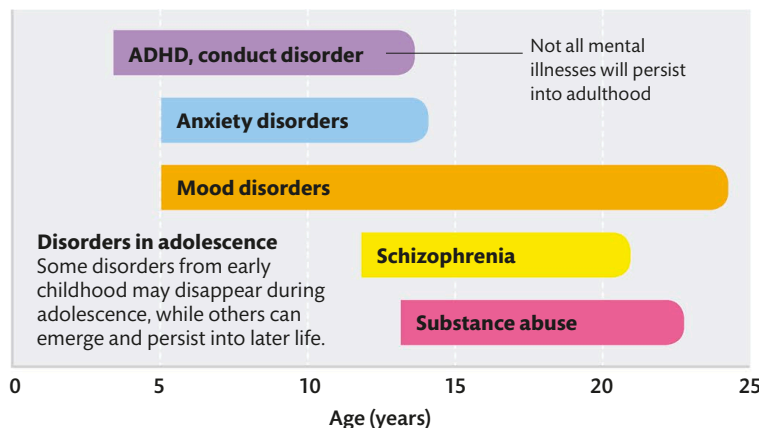


Peer pressure

Teenagers care deeply about how their friends see them. They take more risks with peers, and being left out can feel excruciating. Peer pressure can be a strong influence on them—for good or bad.

Mental health risks

Some of the brain areas that undergo the most dramatic changes during adolescence have been linked with mental ill-health. These changes can leave the brain vulnerable to small issues becoming dysfunctions. This may explain why so many mental health problems, from schizophrenia to anxiety disorders, commonly appear during adolescence.



THE BRAIN REACHES ITS LARGEST PHYSICAL SIZE BETWEEN AGES 11 AND 14



WHY ARE TEENS SELF-CONSCIOUS?

When we think about being embarrassed, a region of our prefrontal cortex linked to understanding mental states is more active in teenagers than adults.